- Place yourself so the person can see you and fairly close – increased volume not always helpful.
- Make sure you have the persons attention before speaking.
- Have doctor check for and remove wax if needed.
- Arrange for hearing assessment and provide support to use a hearing aid if needed.

7.6.4 Taste and Sweet

- Four basic taste (Sweet, Sour, Salty and Bitter) are particularly dulled in older people.
- Changes in the sense of smell are related to cell loss in the nasal passage and in the olfactory bulb in the brain.
- Environmental factors such as long term exposure to toxins (Dust, Pollen and Smoke) contribute to the cellular damage.

Management

- May enjoy smaller attractive meals help to smell food preparation.
- Serve the food in attractive ways.

7.6.5 Skin

- Age related changes the thickness of epidermis decreases along with loss of moisture making the skin dry and rough.
- The melanocyte number decline which reduces protection against Sun rays and leads to appearance of small hypopigmentedspots.
- In the dermis the fibroblast number and the production of extracellular matrix decreases causing wrinkling of the skin.
- Scalp are turns grey due to loss of melanin.
- Growth of nails slows down.



Management

- Use of moisturizers are bath oils can make bath tub slippery.
- As a care provider keep nails short
- Pat gently when helping to dry after bathing.
- Bottom of feet may be core pay attention to foot dear.
- May feel cooler than others but be more at risk of sun stroke.
- Use sun screen hats long sleeves.
- Be careful with such things as hot water bottles.

7.7 COMMON DISEASE CONDITIONS

7.7.1 The most common problems in the elderly are

1. Cardiovascular problem
   e.g..coronary artery diseases (Angina, acute coronary syndrome, myocardial infarction) hypertension.

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